

Digital Customer Care Agent: Business Requirements

Cymbal Energy · Customer Operations · Draft v0.9 for the CX agent pilot

1. Background

Cymbal Energy delivers electricity and natural gas to about 212,000 homes and businesses along the Mississippi Gulf Coast, including Pascagoula, Moss Point, Gautier and Ocean Springs. Our contact center handles about 90,000 contacts a month. During tropical storms, contact volume rises up to eight times in a single day, hold times pass 40 minutes, and most callers only want to know whether we know about their outage and when their power will be back.

2. Goal

Launch a customer care agent on the web and on the phone that resolves the two highest-volume contact types, outages and billing, without a human representative, and hands everything else to a representative with context.

3. In-scope customer journeys

#	Journey	What the agent must do
1	Check outage status	Look up the outage by the ZIP code of the service address. Give status, cause, crew status and estimated restoration time exactly as the outage system returns them.
2	Report a problem	Create a trouble ticket for no power, flickering lights or partial power. A downed or sparking line is always an emergency: tell the caller to stay 35 feet away.
3	Balance and due date	Verify the customer, then give the balance, due date and last payment.
4	Payment arrangement	For customers who cannot pay in full, set up an installment plan if the billing system approves it.
5	Gas odor or leak	Read the approved gas safety script word for word and transfer immediately to emergency dispatch. No troubleshooting.

4. Business rules

- Verify identity with the 6-digit account number and the service ZIP code before sharing any account information.
- Never estimate or round restoration times, balances or dates. Only the systems of record are allowed to state them.
- Never take payment card or bank details in the conversation. Payments go to cymbalenergy.example/pay or 1-800-555-0142.
- Customers can ask for a person at any time. The representative must receive the customer's name and reason for contact.
- Tone: warm, calm, plain-spoken, short. Many customers are stressed, in the dark, or worried about money.

5. Systems the agent can call (tool catalog)

System	Operation	Input	Returns
Customer Information System	verify_customer	account number, ZIP	verified yes/no, customer name, service address

Outage Management System	check_outage	ZIP code	status, cause, customers affected, crew status, estimated restoration
Work Management	report_outage	ZIP code, description	ticket number, priority
Billing	get_bill_summary	(verified customer)	balance, due date, days past due, last payment
Billing	create_payment_arrangement	number of installments	approved yes/no, reason, monthly amount

5a. Test data for the pilot build (use these in mock responses)

Until the systems above are connected, each operation should return realistic mock data built from this test set:

Operation	Mock behavior
verify_customer	Verified only when account number 123456 and ZIP 39562 are both given: customer Patrick Haggerty, 3702 Magnolia St, Moss Point, MS 39562. Anything else: not verified, ask the customer to check the bill.
check_outage	ZIP 39562 : active outage OUT-58840, tree limb on a distribution line, 310 customers affected, crew en route, estimated restoration 4:30 PM today. Any other ZIP: no known outage.
report_outage	Returns a ticket such as TKT-204817 , priority Standard (Emergency when the description mentions a downed or sparking line), and a one-sentence confirmation for the customer.
get_bill_summary	Balance \$238.45, due October 8, not past due, last payment \$212.10 on September 8.
create_payment_arrangement	Returns an arrangement ID such as PA-123456-4 and the monthly amount (balance divided by the installments).

6. Out of scope for the pilot

- Starting, stopping or transferring service (phase 2).
- Taking payments in the conversation.
- Commercial and industrial accounts.

7. Success measures

- Containment of 60% for outage and billing contacts within 90 days.
- Customer satisfaction of 4.3 out of 5 or higher.
- Zero incorrect restoration times or balances quoted by the agent.
- Every gas odor contact transferred in under 30 seconds.